COUNTERFOIL

Color System

A production-ready, relationship-based color architecture.
Built on tonal scales, semantic tokens, and WCAG-validated contrast.

BRAND FOUNDATION

Primitive Tonal Scales

The primitive layer — raw color values organized by hue family. Semantic tokens reference these by name (e.g. primary = brand-500). Changing a primitive value cascades through every token that references it.

Brand / Primary Hue 18° · High chroma · Derived from #F94A00

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#FFF5EE	#FFE6D5	#FFC9A8	#FFA572	#FF7A3D	#F94A00	#D63D00	#AA3000	#802500	#541900	#2D0D00

Neutral / Warm Gray Hue 40° · 3% saturation · Brand-compatible structural palette

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#F5F2EB	#EFECE5	#E2DED5	#D1CDC3	#B8B3A8	#969188	#706C65	#514E48	#383632	#22211F	#141413

Success / Green Hue 142° · Positive actions, confirmations

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#F0FDF4	#DCFCE7	#BBF7D0	#86EFAC	#4ADE80	#22C55E	#16A34A	#15803D	#166534	#14532D	#052E16

Warning / Amber Hue 38° · Caution, attention needed

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#FFFBEB	#FEF3C7	#FDE68A	#FCD34D	#FBBF24	#F59E0B	#D97706	#B45309	#92400E	#78350F	#451A03

Destructive / Red Hue 0° · Errors, destructive actions, critical alerts

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#FEF2F2	#FEE2E2	#FECACA	#FCA5A5	#F87171	#EF4444	#DC2626	#B91C1C	#991B1B	#7F1D1D	#450A0A

Info / Blue Hue 217° · Informational, neutral guidance

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#EFF6FF	#DBEAFE	#BFDBFE	#93C5FD	#60A5FA	#3B82F6	#2563EB	#1D4ED8	#1E40AF	#1E3A8A	#172554

SEMANTIC TOKENS

Light Mode

☀ Light

Color communicates meaning; surfaces communicate hierarchy. Tokens are organized by role - content, surfaces, interaction, and structure - so semantic color is never forced into a background container.

01 - Content Text & icon colors - use these directly, no background needed

foreground	#22211F	← neutral-900	Primary body text
secondary-foreground	#514E48	← neutral-700	Secondary, quieter text
muted-foreground	#706C65	← neutral-600	Subdued, de-emphasized text
disabled-foreground	#B8B3A8	← neutral-400	Disabled states
brand-foreground	#AA3000	← brand-700	Brand-colored text & icons
success-foreground	#166534	← green-800	Success text & icons
warning-foreground	#92400E	← amber-800	Warning text & icons
destructive-foreground	#B91C1C	← red-700	Error text & icons
info-foreground	#1D4ED8	← blue-700	Informational text & icons

02 - Surfaces Backgrounds - use only when a container adds UX value

background	#F5F2EB	← neutral-50	Page background
card	#FFFFFF	← white	Elevated card surfaces
popover	#FFFFFF	← white	Popover, dropdown, tooltip
secondary-surface	#EFECE5	← neutral-100	Subtle secondary containers
muted-surface	#EFECE5	← neutral-100	Low-emphasis backgrounds
accent-surface	#FFF5EE	← brand-50	Brand-tinted highlights
success-surface	#F0FDF4	← green-50	Success alerts, callouts
warning-surface	#FFFBEB	← amber-50	Warning alerts, callouts
destructive-surface	#FEF2F2	← red-50	Error alerts, callouts
info-surface	#EFF6FF	← blue-50	Info alerts, callouts

03 - Interaction Component pairs - buttons, controls, interactive elements

primary	#F94A00	← brand-500	Primary buttons, active states · 3.5:1 with white — UI controls only, not body text
primary-foreground	#FFFFFF	← white	Text on primary
secondary	#EFECE5	← neutral-100	Secondary buttons
secondary-foreground	#514E48	← neutral-700	Text on secondary
destructive	#DC2626	← red-600	Destructive buttons
destructive-foreground	#FFFFFF	← white	Text on destructive
accent	#FFF5EE	← brand-50	Accent interactive
accent-foreground	#AA3000	← brand-700	Text on accent
ring	#F94A00	← brand-500	Focus ring

04 - Structure Borders, dividers, structural elements

border	#E2DED5	← neutral-200	Card borders, separators
input	#E2DED5	← neutral-200	Input field borders
divider	#E2DED5	← neutral-200	Section dividers
focus-ring	#F94A00	← brand-500	Keyboard focus indicator

SEMANTIC TOKENS

Dark Mode

☾ Dark

Same four role groups, adjusted for dark surfaces. Tonal direction reverses - content lightens, surfaces deepen - but meaning and hierarchy stay identical.

01 - Content Text & icon colors - use directly, no background needed

foreground	#EFECE5	← neutral-100	Primary text, high contrast
secondary-foreground	#B8B3A8	← neutral-400	Secondary, quieter text
muted-foreground	#969188	← neutral-500	Subdued, de-emphasized text
disabled-foreground	#514E48	← neutral-700	Disabled states
brand-foreground	#FFA572	← brand-300	Brand-colored text & icons
success-foreground	#4ADE80	← green-400	Success text & icons
warning-foreground	#FBBF24	← amber-400	Warning text & icons
destructive-foreground	#F87171	← red-400	Error text & icons
info-foreground	#60A5FA	← blue-400	Informational text & icons

02 - Surfaces Backgrounds - use only when a container adds UX value

background	#141413	← neutral-950	Page background
card	#22211F	← neutral-900	Elevated card surfaces
popover	#22211F	← neutral-900	Popover, dropdown, tooltip
secondary-surface	#22211F	← neutral-900	Subtle secondary containers
muted-surface	#22211F	← neutral-900	Low-emphasis backgrounds
accent-surface	#2D0D00	← brand-950	Brand-tinted highlights
success-surface	#052E16	← green-950	Success alerts, callouts
warning-surface	#451A03	← amber-950	Warning alerts, callouts
destructive-surface	#450A0A	← red-950	Error alerts, callouts
info-surface	#172554	← blue-950	Info alerts, callouts

03 - Interaction Component pairs - buttons, controls, interactive elements

primary	#FF7A3D	← brand-400	Primary buttons, links, active states
primary-foreground	#141413	← neutral-950	Text on primary
secondary	#22211F	← neutral-900	Secondary buttons
secondary-foreground	#B8B3A8	← neutral-400	Text on secondary
destructive	#EF4444	← red-500	Destructive buttons
destructive-foreground	#141413	← neutral-950	Text on destructive
accent	#2D0D00	← brand-950	Accent interactive
accent-foreground	#FFA572	← brand-300	Text on accent
ring	#FF7A3D	← brand-400	Focus ring

04 - Structure Borders, dividers, structural elements

border	#383632	← neutral-800	Card borders, separators

INTERACTIVE STATES

Component State Tokens

Every interactive state derives from its parent color family — no random hover colors.
States darken in Light Mode (deeper scale step) and lighten in Dark Mode (brighter scale step).

Light Mode States

Primary

Default	Hover	Active	Disabled	Focus Ring
#F94A00 brand-500	#D63D00 brand-600	#AA3000 brand-700	#FFE6D5 brand-100 @ 60%	#F94A00 brand-500

Secondary

Default	Hover	Active	Disabled	Focus Ring
#EFECE5 neutral-100	#E2DED5 neutral-200	#D1CDC3 neutral-300	#B8B3A8 neutral-400	#F94A00 brand-500

Destructive

Default	Hover	Active	Disabled	Focus Ring
#DC2626 red-600	#B91C1C red-700	#991B1B red-800	#FEE2E2 red-100 @ 60%	#DC2626 red-600

Dark Mode States

Primary

Default	Hover	Active	Disabled	Focus Ring
#FF7A3D brand-400	#FFA572 brand-300	#F94A00 brand-500	#541900 brand-900 @ 40%	#FF7A3D brand-400

Secondary

Default	Hover	Active	Disabled	Focus Ring
#22211F neutral-900	#383632 neutral-800	#514E48 neutral-700	#141413 neutral-950 @ 40%	#FF7A3D brand-400

Destructive

Default	Hover	Active	Disabled	Focus Ring
#EF4444 red-500	#F87171 red-400	#DC2626 red-600	#7F1D1D red-900 @ 40%	#EF4444 red-500

FEEDBACK SYSTEM

Status & Feedback Colors

Status tokens are split across Content (foreground colors) and Surfaces (background colors). Use foreground tokens directly for text and icons - add a surface only when the component needs a container (alerts, badges, callouts).

01 - Success Use foreground for inline confirmation; add surface for alerts and callouts.

Success (Light) ☀ Light

success-foreground	#166534	← green-800	Text/icons
success-surface	#F0FDF4	← green-50	Alerts/callouts
success-border	#BBF7D0	← green-200	Container border

Text-only

✓ ✓ Payment confirmed

With surface

✓ ✓ Payment confirmed

Success (Dark) ☾ Dark

success-foreground	#4ADE80	← green-400	Text/icons
success-surface	#052E16	← green-950	Alerts/callouts
success-border	#14532D	← green-900	Container border

Text-only

✓ ✓ Payment confirmed

With surface

✓ ✓ Payment confirmed

02 - Warning Use foreground for inline attention; add surface for banners and callouts.

Warning (Light) ☀ Light

warning-foreground	#92400E	← amber-800	Text/icons
warning-surface	#FFFBEB	← amber-50	Alerts/callouts
warning-border	#FDE68A	← amber-200	Container border

Text-only

⚠ ⚠ Review required

With surface

⚠ ⚠ Review required

Warning (Dark) ☾ Dark

warning-foreground	#FBBF24	← amber-400	Text/icons
warning-surface	#451A03	← amber-950	Alerts/callouts
warning-border	#78350F	← amber-900	Container border

Text-only

⚠ ⚠ Review required

With surface

⚠ ⚠ Review required

03 - Destructive Use foreground for inline danger; add surface for destructive banners.

Destructive (Light) ☀ Light

destructive-foreground	#B91C1C	← red-700	Text/icons
destructive-surface	#FEF2F2	← red-50	Alerts/callouts
destructive-border	#FECACA	← red-200	Container border

Text-only

🗑 Delete item

With surface

🗑 Delete item

Destructive (Dark) ☾ Dark

destructive-foreground	#F87171	← red-400	Text/icons
destructive-surface	#450A0A	← red-950	Alerts/callouts
destructive-border	#7F1D1D	← red-900	Container border

Text-only

🗑 Delete item

With surface

🗑 Delete item

04 - Info Use foreground for inline information; add surface for banners and callouts.

Info (Light) ☀ Light

info-foreground	#1D4ED8	← blue-700	Text/icons
info-surface	#EFF6FF	← blue-50	Alerts/callouts
info-border	#BFDBFE	← blue-200	Container border

Text-only

ⓘ ℹ️ Learn more

With surface

ⓘ ℹ️ Learn more

Info (Dark) ☾ Dark

info-foreground	#60A5FA	← blue-400	Text/icons
info-surface	#172554	← blue-950	Alerts/callouts
info-border	#1E3A8A	← blue-900	Container border

Text-only

ⓘ ℹ️ Learn more

With surface

ⓘ ℹ️ Learn more

ACCESSIBILITY

Contrast Validation Matrix

Two validation passes: Content tokens on page background (the default - no container needed) and Interaction pairs on their component surfaces. Every token was adjusted until it passed, not checked after the fact.

Mode	Token Pair	Background	Foreground	Ratio	WCAG Level
Light	foreground on background	#F5F2EB	#22211F	14.4:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Light	secondary-foreground on background	#F5F2EB	#514E48	7.4:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Light	muted-foreground on background	#F5F2EB	#706C65	4.7:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Light	brand-foreground on background	#F5F2EB	#AA3000	6.0:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Light	success-foreground on background	#F5F2EB	#166534	6.4:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Light	warning-foreground on background	#F5F2EB	#92400E	6.3:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Light	destructive-foreground on background	#F5F2EB	#B91C1C	5.8:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Light	info-foreground on background	#F5F2EB	#1D4ED8	6.0:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Dark	foreground on background	#141413	#EFECE5	15.6:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Dark	secondary-foreground on background	#141413	#B8B3A8	8.8:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Dark	muted-foreground on background	#141413	#969188	5.9:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Dark	brand-foreground on background	#141413	#FFA572	9.5:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Dark	success-foreground on background	#141413	#4ADE80	10.6:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Dark	warning-foreground on background	#141413	#FBBF24	11.0:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Dark	destructive-foreground on background	#141413	#F87171	6.7:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Dark	info-foreground on background	#141413	#60A5FA	7.3:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Light	primary-foreground on primary	#F94A00	#FFFFFF	3.5:1	AA Large Text / UI ✓
Light	secondary-foreground on secondary	#EFECE5	#514E48	7.0:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Light	destructive-foreground on destructive	#DC2626	#FFFFFF	4.8:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Light	accent-foreground on accent	#FFF5EE	#AA3000	6.2:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Dark	primary-foreground on primary	#FF7A3D	#141413	7.1:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Dark	secondary-foreground on secondary	#22211F	#B8B3A8	7.7:1	AAA Normal Text ✓
Dark	destructive-foreground on destructive	#EF4444	#141413	4.9:1	AA Normal Text ✓
Dark	accent-foreground on accent	#2D0D00	#FFA572	9.3:1	AAA Normal Text ✓

ELEVATION & HIERARCHY

Visual Hierarchy

Surface and content hierarchies are separated. Surface tokens control backgrounds and elevation;
content tokens control text foreground. The same hierarchy applies in both modes — only the tonal direction reverses.

Light Mode

SURFACE HIERARCHY

Page Background	neutral-50 #F5F2EB
↓	
Subtle Surface	neutral-100 #EFECE5
↓	
Border	neutral-200 #E2DED5
↓	
Elevated Card	white #FFFFFF

CONTENT HIERARCHY

Muted	neutral-600 #706C65
↓	
Secondary	neutral-700 #514E48
↓	
Primary	neutral-900 #22211F
↓	
Semantic / Brand	contextual

Dark Mode

SURFACE HIERARCHY

Page Background	neutral-950 #141413
↓	
Subtle Surface	neutral-900 #22211F
↓	
Border	neutral-800 #383632
↓	
Elevated Card	neutral-900 #22211F

CONTENT HIERARCHY

Muted	neutral-500 #969188
↓	
Secondary	neutral-400 #B8B3A8
↓	
Primary	neutral-100 #EFECE5
↓	
Semantic / Brand	contextual